blow to these groups, and now more and more of them are coming around for talks with the Government of India. Many of their leaders have been arrested by our security forces and the police. The authorities in Bangladesh have also handed over many of their cadres, including some prominent leaders, to our Border Security Force. The chairman of the banned ULFA, Arabinda Rajkhowa, was released on bail on 1 January 2011, and he has publicly stated that ULFA is committed to working for lasting peace in Assam. Many other leaders of this organization have also similarly been released so that meaningful peace talks could be commenced with the Government of India. This development augurs well for peace and prosperity in the region.

The ULFA signed a suspension of operations agreement with the Government of India on 4 September 2011. However, after the heat raised in Bangladesh, the self-styled commander-in-chief of ULFA, Paresh Barua, and others moved to Myanmar. These groups are opposed to any dialogue without the sovereignty issue being on the agenda. On 8 September 2011, the Myanmar army launched operations on the camps of ULFA, NSCN (K) and other terrorist groups holed up in Myanmar. The government is hopeful of arriving at a peaceful solution of the Assam problem as a result of the ongoing parleys with the ULFA leaders. At present there is a democratically elected Congress government led by Tarun Gogoi, which has won the elections for a second term.

Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh and Meghalaya are amongst the most peaceful states in the NE. There are two districts of Arunachal Pradesh bordering Nagaland which have a spillover of Naga insurgency, where cases of illegal tax collection, extortion, coercion, kidnapping and forcible recruitment have been taking place. However, the situation has not been allowed to deteriorate or spread to other parts of the state. More than a hundred misguided youth from Tirap District surrendered during 2009–10 because of frustration and a desire to return to the national mainstream. Sikkim has shown a remarkable improvement in governance. It is forging ahead in the domain of tourism. The socioeconomic condition of the people has shown an upward trend. The 2011 earthquake in Sikkim